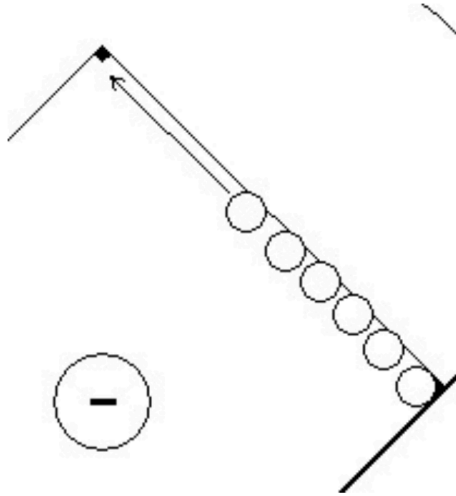


Purpose:

This drill teaches players the proper sliding technique to beat a tag-out play while minimizing the risk of injury.



Players work on proper sliding technique.

Setup:

- Create a couple of stations, each with a line of players and a bag to slide into.
- Ensure ample space for players to approach and slide safely.

Instructions:

1. Before running the drill, demonstrate and instruct players on proper sliding technique:
 - The player should create a triangle with their legs.
 - Slide using the leg underneath while keeping the top foot free to touch the bag.
2. Teach players to avoid sliding directly on their backside, as this can be painful. Emphasize sliding with the back side of their thigh for better control and safety.
3. Players will take turns running toward the bag and sliding into it at each station.
4. Once players gain confidence, gradually increase the speed and add realistic game situations.

Coaching Tips:

- Once players master the sliding technique, introduce scenarios that require sliding, such as avoiding a tag during a close play.
- Add a defensive player who attempts to tag the sliding player to simulate in-game pressure.
- For beginners, start teaching sliding in the outfield grass where the surface is softer before progressing to the infield dirt.

Coaching Tips for Younger Athletes:

- Use visual cues like “triangle legs” and “foot to the bag” to help young players understand and remember the proper form.
- Have players practice sliding in slow motion first to build confidence before increasing speed.
- Ensure a controlled environment, focusing on safety by reminding players to keep their hands and head up when sliding.

Coaching Tips for Older Athletes:

- Emphasize timing and decision-making, teaching players to recognize when to slide to avoid being tagged out.
- Focus on improving slide variations, such as the hook slide or pop-up slide, to add versatility to their base running.
- Reinforce explosiveness in their approach to the bag to ensure they maintain speed while preparing to slide.